

Illustrative render of the finished design - not a photograph of a sample

Ember the Baby Dragon

Baby dragon with matched open head and neck seams · scalloped wings · 10.5 cm seated

CROCHET PATTERN · US TERMS · INTERMEDIATE · 4 HOURS · INK-FRIENDLY PRINT LAYOUT

✓ 5-AXIOM MATH VERIFIED ON PAPER	18-ST NECK	SCALLOP WINGS	MATCHED SEAMS	DK #3

SAGE - BODY CREAM - BELLY named original colourway

WHAT YOU GET	VERIFICATION	PRINT NOTES
Baby dragon with matched open head and neck seams Full US-terms instruction tables Finishing, troubleshooting and care pages	✓ 5-axiom mathematical audit All round counts re-derived exactly Paper-verified: no sample crocheted	US Letter, no full-bleed colour Tables sized for home printers Checklist and record pages included

Every proportion pinned, counted and re-derived

each piece is worked in the order listed and sewn in the numbered assembly sequence; all stitch counts in this edition re-derive exactly from the written rounds.

Paper-verified edition: every stitch count, repeat multiplier, chain length and decrease schedule in this document was re-derived from its own instruction text. No sample was crocheted, blocked, weighed or measured, so all sizes, yarn quantities and times are targets for you to confirm on your first make.

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Cover artwork is an illustrative render of the written design - not a photograph of a sample.

A chunky, big-headed baby dragon with a stubby snout, scalloped wings and a ridge of spikes down the back. She sits, with folding haunches and splayed front legs.

FINISHED SIZE About 10.5 cm (a touch over 4 in) tall seated - 103 mm by the gauge. 12.4 cm (just under 5 in) wingspan. About 5 cm (2 in) tail. A sitting dragon - her body rests on the table and her legs pose rather than lift her.

Safety — read this first

Ember uses two 10 mm plastic safety eyes. If an eye, washer or surrounding stitch fails, it can release a small part: lock each washer from the inside before the head is joined to the body, then check the eye and fabric by hand. An embroidered-eye version removes those plastic components but does not establish age suitability.

No finished Ember has been shown by Novality Store to comply with ASTM F963, EN 71 or another toy-safety regime. Calling the item “decorative” does not replace classification based on intended or reasonably foreseeable use. Before supply, the finished-item maker or seller must determine and meet all applicable assessment, testing, documentation, labelling and traceability duties in every destination market.

Materials

- Main yarn: worsted #4, about 12 g used (a 25 g ball is plenty) - sage green, dusty teal, lilac or charcoal. The extra allows for tails, seaming and a gauge swatch.
- Contrast yarn: worsted #4, about 5 g in a contrast cream or pale gold - used for the wings, horns and spikes, so all the details match.
- Hook: 3.5 mm (US E/4).
- Eyes: 2 x 10 mm safety eyes - slit-pupil dragon eyes if you can get them.
- Also needed: polyester fibre fill about 10 g; a small amount of dark embroidery floss for the nostrils; tapestry needle; stitch markers; pins.

Gauge & size

Gauge: about 4.5 mm per stitch and 4.3 mm per round. Check on the body after Rnd 5 - 30 stitches should measure about 43 mm across when filled. If your stitches are wider, crochet more tightly or drop to a 3.0 mm hook or the stuffing will show.

Abbreviations (US terms)

MR - magic ring · ch - chain

sc - single crochet · hdc - half double crochet

dc - double crochet · inc - increase (2 sc in one st)

dec - invisible decrease · sl st - slip stitch

picot - ch 2, sl st in 2nd ch from hook · FO - fasten off

st(s) - stitch(es) · Rnd(s) - round(s) · (n) - stitch count at round end

Work in a continuous spiral unless a row says to turn; mark the first stitch of every round. The wings and the spike strip are the exceptions - both are worked flat. Work every stitch through both loops unless a note says otherwise.

Techniques used, in the order you will meet them

The magic ring - The head, body, limbs, tail and horns begin with a magic ring. Pull the tail tight once the round is complete. The flat wings and spike strip begin with chains instead.

Working in a spiral - Keep a stitch marker in the first stitch of every round; there is no join to count from.

Matched open joins - Ember's head and her neck are BOTH left open at 18 stitches, so the two edges are the same size and can be ladder-stitched together cleanly. This is the single most important structural detail - the head is heavy and this joint carries all of it. Do not close the head down to a point; stop at 18 stitches. Closing a heavy dragon head down to 6 stitches leaves a small gathered point sewn to a wide neck ring - a tiny seam carrying a big head, which is exactly why a dragon's head flops.

Notes

How the size adds up: body Rnd 1-13 is 13 rounds at 4.3 mm each, about 56 mm; head Rnd 1-11 is 11 rounds at 4.3 mm each, about 47 mm; seated together 56 + 47 = 103 mm - about 10.5 cm. Wingspan: 45 + 34 + 45 = 124 mm - just under 12.5 cm. Tail: 12 rounds at 4.3 mm each, about 52 mm - about 5 cm.

Instructions

1. Head - main colour (worked top-down)

Worked top-down and LEFT OPEN - stop at 18 stitches, then fasten off without cinching the opening. Place the eye stems after Rnd 8 while the head is still wide open. Leave a long tail if you want a spare sewing strand. A big head is what makes a dragon read as a baby dragon. Two straight rounds only, then the decreases.

Rnd	Instruction	Sts	Note
R1	6 sc in MR	(6)	-
R2	inc in each st around	(12)	-
R3	[sc, inc] x 6	(18)	-
R4	[2 sc, inc] x 6	(24)	-
R5	[3 sc, inc] x 6	(30)	-
R6	[4 sc, inc] x 6	(36)	head at full width
R7	sc in each st around	(36)	eyes at R7 - R8
R8	sc in each st around	(36)	insert and LOCK eye washers now
R9	[4 sc, dec] x 6	(30)	-
R10	[3 sc, dec] x 6	(24)	begin stuffing
R11	[2 sc, dec] x 6	(18)	LEAVE OPEN - matches neck

After Rnd 8, place the eye stems between Rnds 7 and 8, eight stitches apart, and lock both washers while the opening is still wide. Continue Rnds 9-11, stuffing firmly from Rnd 10. After Rnd 11, FO without decreasing or cinching; leave the 18-stitch edge open for sewing to the body's neck. Sew on the snout after the head is shaped. If embroidering eyes instead, complete them before joining the head to the body.

2. Snout (make 1) - main colour

Rnd	Instruction	Sts	Note
R1	6 sc in MR	(6)	-
R2	[sc, inc] x 3	(9)	-
R3	[2 sc, inc] x 3	(12)	-
R4	sc in each st around	(12)	-
R5	sc in each st around	(12)	-

Finish: FO with a long tail and stuff lightly. Before attaching, embroider two small nostrils at the tip and knot their ends inside through the open 12-stitch edge. Pin the snout centred on Rnds 8-11 of the head, just below the eye line, and sew all the way around. It must project past the curve of the head, not sit flush - a dragon without a projecting snout reads as a bear.

3. Body - main colour (worked bottom-up)

Worked bottom-up. The neck is left open at 18 stitches so the head can be seated on it. Pack the neck firmly before you join the head - a soft neck is what lets the head flop forward.

Rnd	Instruction	Sts	Note
R1	6 sc in MR	(6)	-
R2	inc in each st around	(12)	-
R3	[sc, inc] x 6	(18)	-
R4	[2 sc, inc] x 6	(24)	tail attaches R4 - R6
R5	[3 sc, inc] x 6	(30)	full width - check gauge
R6	sc in each st around	(30)	back legs at R6
R7	sc in each st around	(30)	-
R8	sc in each st around	(30)	front legs at R8
R9	sc in each st around	(30)	-
R10	[3 sc, dec] x 6	(24)	wings at R10 - R11
R11	sc in each st around	(24)	-
R12	[2 sc, dec] x 6	(18)	stuff firmly
R13	sc in each st around	(18)	LEAVE THE NECK OPEN

Finish: FO with a 40 cm tail; do not close. When you join the head, ladder-stitch all the way around and then make a second pass and pull it tight - this joint carries the whole head.

4. Legs (make 4) - main colour

Rnd	Instruction	Sts	Note
R1	6 sc in MR	(6)	all four
R2	[sc, inc] x 3	(9)	all four
R3	sc in each st around	(9)	all four
R4	sc in each st around	(9)	all four
R5	sc in each st around	(9)	all four
R6	sc in each st around	(9)	BACK legs finish here
R7	sc in each st around	(9)	front legs only
R8	sc in each st around	(9)	front legs only

Finish: stuff the lower half lightly and leave the top 3 rounds soft; FO with a long tail. Press the 9-stitch opening flat - 4 stitches in front, 4 behind, the odd stitch tucked into the fold - and the leg mouth sews shut when you attach it. The pairs are different lengths on purpose: back legs (6 rnd / 26 mm) attach at Rnd 6, 26 mm up; front legs (8 rnd / 34 mm) attach at Rnd 8, 34 mm up. A higher join needs a longer leg so all four feet reach the table. Sew each pair about eight stitches apart; angle the back legs under as haunches and the front legs slightly forward. The body rests on the table - the legs pose, they don't lift her.

5. Tail - main colour

Worked from the tip up so it tapers naturally.

Rnd	Instruction	Sts	Note
R1	4 sc in MR	(4)	tip
R2	sc in each st around	(4)	-
R3	[sc, inc] x 2	(6)	-
R4	sc in each st around	(6)	-
R5	sc in each st around	(6)	-
R6	[2 sc, inc] x 2	(8)	-
R7	sc in each st around	(8)	-
R8	sc in each st around	(8)	-
R9	[3 sc, inc] x 2	(10)	-
R10	sc in each st around	(10)	-
R11	sc in each st around	(10)	-
R12	sc in each st around	(10)	base

Finish: stuff lightly, FO with a long tail, flatten the open end and sew it to the back of the body at Rnds 4-6.

6. Horns - contrast colour (make 2)

Rnd	Instruction	Sts	Note
R1	4 sc in MR	(4)	-
R2	sc in each st around	(4)	-
R3	[sc, inc] x 2	(6)	-
R4	sc in each st around	(6)	-
R5	sc in each st around	(6)	-

Finish: do not stuff; FO with a long tail. Sew to the crown of the head, 6 stitches apart, angled back.

7. Wings - contrast colour (make 2, worked flat)

Ch 11. Work in turned rows (ch 1 and turn at each row end):

Rnd	Instruction	Sts	Note
Found.	ch 11	-	-
Row 1	from the 2nd ch: sc in 4, hdc in 3, dc in 3	(10)	-
Row 2	sc in 3, hdc in 3, dc in 4	(10)	-
Row 3	sc in 2, hdc in 4, dc in 4	(10)	-
Row 4	sl st in first 2, (sc, hdc, dc, hdc, sc) all in next st, sl st in next 2, (sc, hdc, dc, hdc, sc) all in next st, sl st in last 4	(18)	scalloped edge - FO with a 25 cm tail

The scallop maths: the slip-stitch anchors are 2 + 2 + 4 = eight stitches; the two shells each fan from a single stitch (2 more), so all 10 stitches of Row 3 are consumed and nothing is left over. Pin the straight inner edge across Rnds 10-11 and sew the WHOLE edge so the scalloped edge stays free.

8. Spike strip - contrast colour

One flat foundation strip is sewn down the centre back from crown to tail tip. It carries nine pointed fans: 3 on the head, 4 on the body and 2 on the tail.

Foundation: ch 34. Row 1: sc in 2nd ch from hook and in each ch across (33); ch 1, turn.

Spikes: Row 2: sl st in first 3 sts; [sl st in next st, (sc, hdc, dc, picot, dc, hdc, sc) all in next st, sl st in next st] x 9; sl st in last 3 sts. FO with a long tail.

Count check: the two 3-stitch end tabs plus nine 3-anchor spike repeats use all 33 stitches of Row 1 (3 + 27 + 3 = 33). Each fan has one ch-2 picot at its peak; picot chains do not count as row stitches. Sew the straight FOUNDATION edge to Ember and leave the fan edge free.

At the stated gauge, the foundation is about 13.5-15 cm long. PIN the whole strip from crown to tail tip before sewing. If your path is shorter, fold one plain end tab under; if it is longer, add 3 foundation chains and one complete spike repeat. Never stretch only one section.

Finishing & assembly

Assembly - work in this order:

Eyes were inserted between Rnds 7 and 8 and the washers locked immediately after Rnd 8, before the head was stuffed. If embroidering instead, stitch them now.

Embroider and secure the nostrils inside the still-open snout, then sew the snout to the shaped head, centred on Rnds 8-11 below the eye line.

Horns to the crown, 6 stitches apart, angled back.

Head to body: both edges open at 18 stitches. Pack the neck firmly, seat the head and ladder-stitch around, then a second tight pass.

Legs: back pair to Rnd 6, front pair to Rnd 8, angled as described.

Tail to the back of the body at Rnds 4-6.

Wings across Rnds 10-11, sewn along the whole straight edge.

Spike strip LAST - pin from crown to tail tip before you sew a single stitch.

Troubleshooting

- **Head flops forward.** Pack the neck firmly before closing and make the second ladder-stitch pass tight. If it still moves, the edges did not match - both head and neck must be open at 18 stitches.
- **Rocks back onto haunches.** The legs are all the same length and they cannot be. Back legs attach 26 mm up, front 34 mm up - work the back legs 6 rounds and the front 8.
- **Will not sit.** Legs sewn too high, or the base is under-stuffed. Back legs on Rnd 6, front on Rnd 8; keep the lower body firm enough to sit on.
- **Wings droop.** Sew along the whole straight inner edge, not just the top corner.
- **Spike strip is the wrong length / curves.** Row 1 must have 33 sc. Row 2 uses 3-stitch end tabs and nine complete 3-anchor spike repeats. Pin the straight foundation edge from crown to tail before sewing; fold an end tab under or add one 3-chain / one-spike module if needed. This is the most visible seam.
- **Looks like a bear.** The snout is missing or under-stuffed - it must project past the dome of the head.
- **Stuffing shows through.** Gauge too loose - 30 stitches should measure 43 mm across. Crochet tighter or drop to a 3.0 mm hook.

Colorways

Sage green · Dusty teal · Lilac · Charcoal · Blush pink

Designer notes

- The continuous spike ridge runs from crown to tail tip - it is sewn on last and pinned before any stitch.

Care

Follow the labels for every yarn and component used. Before publishing a care claim or supplying finished Embers, clean and dry a complete sample by the proposed method, then remeasure it and inspect for dye transfer, fibre change, stuffing migration, shifted eyes, a loosened neck seam and opened limb, wing, horn or spine seams. Until that sample test passes, recommend gentle surface cleaning with a damp cloth and drying flat away from heat. Reshape the wings and recheck every attachment after cleaning.

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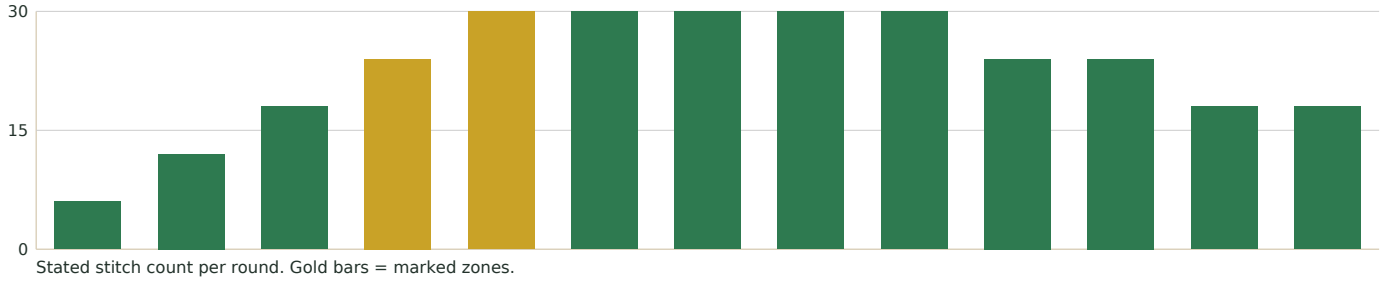
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Appendix A - Assembly Map & Count Chart



Sew faces and small parts first, then join pieces in the numbered assembly order given in Finishing & assembly.



Stated stitch count per round. Gold bars = marked zones.

Appendix B - Count Ladder & Verification Summary

Rnd	Sts
R1	6
R2	12
R3	18
R4	24
R5	30
R6	30
R7	30

Rnd	Sts
R8	30
R9	30
R10	24
R11	24
R12	18
R13	18

Verification summary

Every round count in this pattern was re-derived from its own instructions by an independent auditor (PASS: 13 ladder rows, 0 mismatches) and by the deterministic static-analysis engine crochet-check v1.0.0. No count below is sampled or hand-checked.

Axiom	What it guarantees	Findings
Domain Isolation	Pieces keep separate stitch domains	0
Edge Lineage	Every round consumes exactly the previous total	0
Open Boundaries	Open edges are closed or sewn deliberately	0
Gauge Bounding	Hook and gauge band consistent with stated size	0

Assembly map, count chart, ladder equivalents and the 5-axiom table are computed from the corrected master at compile time; no sampled results.

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